

Social Change

Meiji Period -> also saw transformation in Japanese society.

eg: cities grew rapidly and Tokyo's population rose from about 600 000 in 1873. -> to about 2 000 000 in 1913.

many new city dwellers -> were young people -> who had migrated from countryside for work.

Although those who moved to city remained connected to their families -> many living in the countryside began to observe a divide in terms of values and attitudes.

People -> living in the countryside tended to hold on to more traditional values -> compared to city dwellers.

social hierarchy -> in Japan also began to change.

samurai -> no longer elite class.

-> replaced by new national army and navy -> made up of civilian conscripts.